

Mindshare is eroding while we double down on capture — brand traffic **-25% YoY** as Paid doubled

Mindshare = warm-channel reach (Direct + Organic) → buying intent → inbound core pipeline. All YoY figures compare matched 26-week windows: Dec '24–May '25 vs Dec '25–May '26.

-25%

Warm visits (Direct + Organic)
2.46M → 1.85M

-31%

Warm buying-intent visits
(pricing + demo pages)

-28%

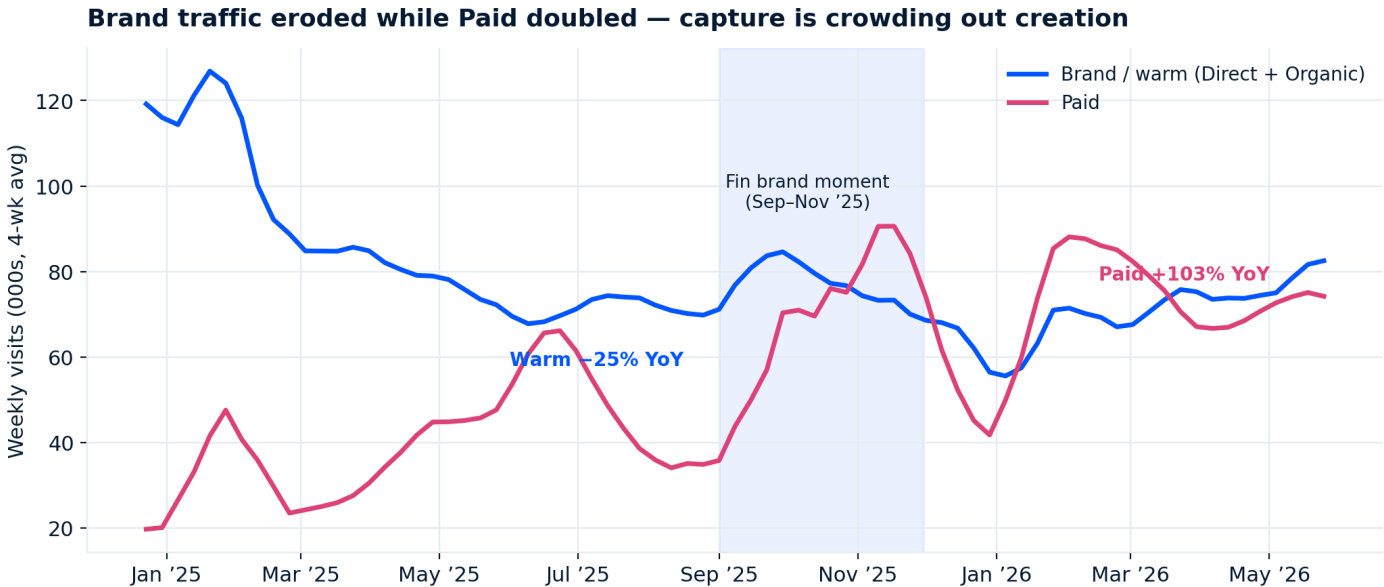
Inbound MQLs
11,742 → 8,409

+103%

Paid visits — while Paid efficiency fell -24% (21.4 → 16.2 conv/1k)

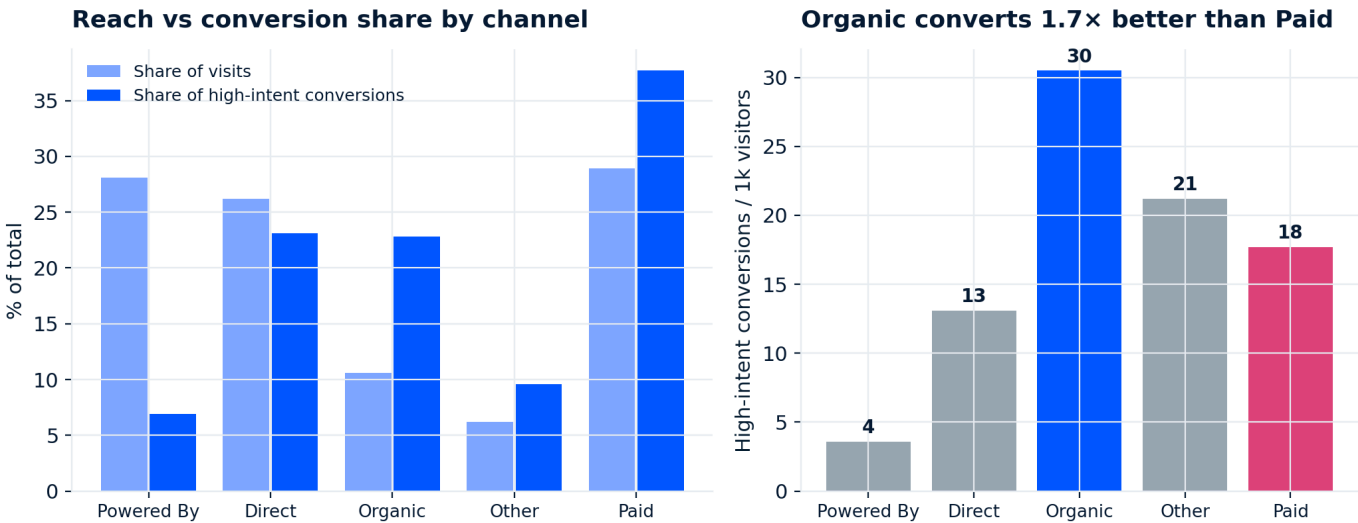
8.6%

MQL→S1 rate, up from 6.5% — smaller funnel, warmer buyers



Brand is not a vanity metric: warm traffic converts up to 1.7× better — and the Fin launch proved it moves pipeline

High-intent conversions = demo form + contact-sales + signup — the events that mint core MQLs (core converts to S1 at 8.1% vs 1.7% non-core; self-directed Contact Sales MQLs convert at 20.4%).



Sep '25 Fin moment — the natural experiment

Launch-quarter brand push: Fin-surface traffic **5.7×** (sustained 8+ months), inbound MQLs +6%, **S1 conversions +20%** (397 → 475) vs prior quarter. Brand investment produced more **and better** pipeline.

Capture is saturating

Paid visits +103% YoY but Paid conversion efficiency **fell 24%** — and total inbound MQLs still dropped 28%. **Capture harvests demand; it can't replace creating it.** Paid is now 42% of marketing visits, up from 15%.

99.6% of MQLs are channel-blind

utm_source is Direct/Unknown on 45.6K of 45.8K MQLs. Attribution can't prove any channel's MQL quality today — paid included. Fixing capture is a zero-cost prerequisite for every ROI debate, and last-touch already under-credits brand.

FY27: shift ~\$3M (15%) from unbranded capture to demand creation → target +285 S1 opps (+20%)

Baseline: ~\$20M paid run-rate proxy (3.7M annualized paid visits × \$5.50 benchmark cost/visit — no spend data in extract; recommendation is a % shift, robust across the \$4–8 benchmark range).

WHERE THE \$3M GOES

INVESTMENT	\$	EVIDENCE
Quarterly Fin brand moments launch-grade campaigns · events · PR	\$1.5M	Sep '25 moment: 5.7× sustained Fin traffic, +20% S1 q/q
EMEA brand program (SB / MM)	\$0.9M	Pipeline share already matches traffic share; SB 11.8% / MM 8.8% S1 — proven conversion
APAC activation fix + localized test	\$0.3M	17% of warm traffic → 2.7% of S1s; repair the leak before scaling spend
Organic/content + Powered By recovery	\$0.3M	Organic = best efficiency (30.5 conv/1k); PB break cost 72% of free reach
Total — funded by trimming the least-efficient marginal paid capture	\$3.0M	

GUARDRAILS — FOR THE VP DEMAND GEN

- **Branded-search floor stays funded.** Cuts come only from unbranded capture, where marginal efficiency already fell 24%.
- **Quarterly stage gates** on leading indicators (warm visits, warm intent visits) with pre-agreed rollback triggers.
- **Measured on pipeline, not impressions:** inbound core MQLs and S1s are the success metrics.

ZERO-COST ACCELERATORS (START DAY 1)

- **Fix UTM capture** — 99.6% of MQLs are channel-blind; every ROI debate is unwinnable until this lands.
- **Enrich the 17% “Unknown-segment” MQLs** (5,625 leads, zero S1 credit) — free pipeline via routing.
- **Diagnose ENT conversion:** only growing segment (MQLs +34% YoY) but 2.9% S1 — rising Fin demand our motion isn’t converting.

REGION POSTURE

- **NAMER** maintain (brand over-delivers: 63% of S1s on 42% of traffic) · **EMEA** grow · **APAC** fix-then-grow · **LATAM** watch.

+285 S1 opportunities / year (+20%)

From recovering **half** the warm-traffic decline at the current 8.6% S1 rate. Sensitivity: +215/yr at the old 6.5% rate · +570/yr on full recovery. Recovery is already starting (Apr–May '26 +3.8% YoY).